these policies, many black leaders claimed that, if I wasn't a bigot, at the very least I was unsympathetic to the aspirations of blacks and other minorities.

Neither claim was true, and I think the record shows that. It is true that I opposed quotas in employment, education, and other areas. I consider quotas, whether they favor blacks or whites, men or women, to be a new form of discrimination as bad as the old ones. But our administration filed plenty of cases to correct civil rights abuses—as many as or more than any previous administration in history. Funding for enforcement of civil rights laws went up eighteen percent over my eight years in office. We took the lead in developing new civil rights legislation that strengthened the Fair Housing Act of 1968. And proportionally, blacks benefited more than any other racial group from our economic policies.

There is still too wide a gap between the average income of blacks in our country and that of other Americans. But the gap narrowed substantially during the eighties: Between November 1982 and November 1988, employment of blacks rose twenty-nine percent while the number of black families in the highest income bracket, $50,000 and over, increased nearly eighty-six percent. During this period, more than 2.6 million blacks were added to the civilian labor force, black employment in the nation's highest-paid occupations jumped almost forty percent, and black unemployment fell from 20.2 percent at the beginning of the expansion to slightly more than ten percent.

During the previous administration, per capita income had increased 2.4 percent for whites and one percent for blacks. Between 1982 and 1988, it rose more than fourteen percent for whites and more than eighteen percent for blacks.

Whatever the reasons for the myth that I'm a racist, I blow my top every time I hear it. In 1987, Supreme Court Justice Thurgood Marshall gave a television interview in which he